Practice workbook · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Judging a specific study in the paper for reliability, validity, generalisability, controls and ethics.

12 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 11 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-21

1. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

3 Alessia is a teacher at a school and is trying to help students learn a new concept in science class.

Alessia split her students into three groups to see who would learn the new concept the most effectively.

- Group 1 – the students were asked to do a very easy task about the new concept, with only very simple activities included.
- Group 2 – the students were asked to do a reasonably difficult task about the new concept, with some slightly more challenging activities included.
- Group 3 – the students were asked to do a very hard, complex task about the new concept, with only extremely challenging activities included.

Alessia asked her students to do the activities in their groups over the course of a week during lessons. At the start and the end of the week the students took the same test about the new science concept.

Alessia wanted to make some conclusions about how the tasks given affected the students' performance in the test.

Figure 1 shows the average performance of the three groups at the start and the end of the week.

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A comparative bar chart to show the average test performance (%) on the new science concept at the start and the end of the week

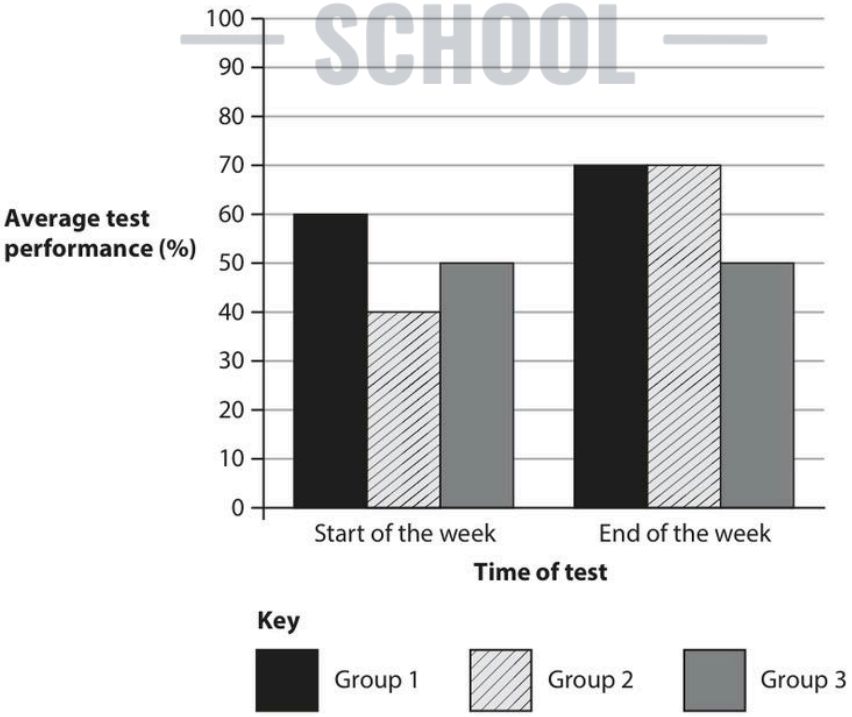


Figure 1

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1. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made using the data in **Figure 1** in terms of how appropriate the tasks given to the three groups of students were in learning a new concept.

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1. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Alessia's investigation into learning a new concept.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 3 = 8 marks)

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1. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

9 Dekota wanted to investigate the difference between retrograde and anterograde amnesia.

She asked one participant with retrograde amnesia and one participant with anterograde amnesia to perform two tasks and recorded their performance.

Task 1: A complex picture was shown to the participants. The participants were asked to reproduce the picture after a 15-minute delay. The reproduction of the picture was scored out of 36.

Task 2: Participants were asked 100 factual questions about real news events that occurred before they suffered from amnesia.

Dekota compared the performance of her two participants with a control participant who did not suffer from amnesia.

Table 1 shows Dekota's results.

	Task 1 Picture task (score out of 36)	Task 2 News events task (score out of 100)
Participant with retrograde amnesia	26	40
Participant with anterograde amnesia	8	80
Control participant with no amnesia	33	97

Table 1

(a) Explain **two** conclusions Dekota could make from the data in **Table 1**.

(4)

Conclusion one:

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2. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

Conclusion two:

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Dekota's study.

(4)

Strength:

Weakness:

(Total for Question 9 = 8 marks)

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2. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

3 Sarah is investigating whether her daughter is able to see the world from the perspective of other people.

She took her daughter to the local park and asked her to look at the playground equipment. She placed a toy robot in a different location to her daughter (see **Figure 1**).

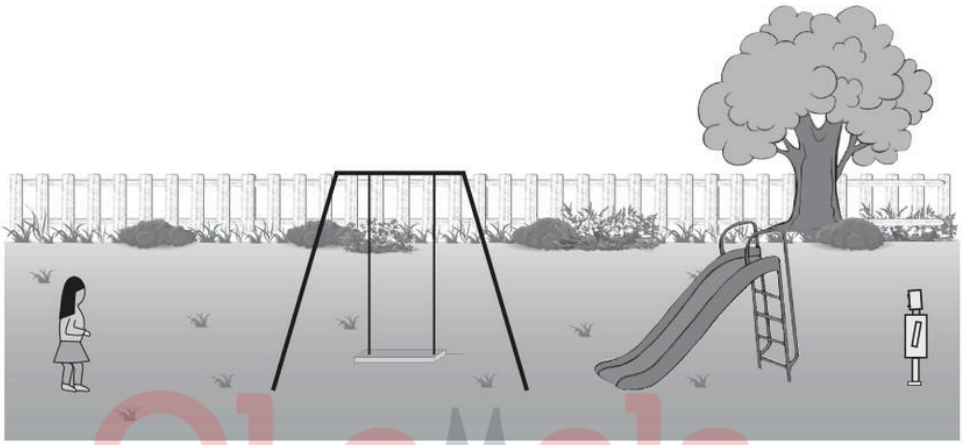


Figure 1

Sarah then asked her daughter to tell her what the toy robot can see.

Her daughter stated that the toy robot can see the swings at the front and the slide at the back.

(a) Explain which stage of cognitive development Sarah's daughter is in according to her statement.

You should refer to Piaget and Inhelder (1956) Three Mountains task in your answer.

(2)

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3. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Sarah's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 3 = 6 marks)

3. Question 3 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 5 · part b · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 Beth is investigating the level of cognitive development of eight-month-old infants.

She is playing with her eight-month-old daughter in her living room at home.

Beth shows her daughter a ball and she reaches for it. Beth hides the ball behind a cushion. Her daughter reaches behind the cushion to get the ball back.

(a) Explain what this shows regarding Beth's daughter's cognitive development.

You should refer to Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development in your answer.

(2)

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4. Question 5 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Beth's investigation into the level of cognitive development of eight-month-old infants.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 5 = 6 marks)

4. Question 5 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

8 Pablo is investigating the memory of some volunteers. He reads out 20 everyday words and asks his volunteers to write down as many as they could remember after he had finished reading the words.

Pablo's word list is shown in **Figure 1**.

Word list

1. Train
2. Stable
3. Cabbage
4. Mattress
5. Uncle
6. Roof
7. Question
8. Cottage
9. Bargain
10. Finger
11. Landscape
12. Future
13. Velvet
14. Stomach
15. Flower
16. Gossip
17. Chamber
18. Sandal
19. Warehouse
20. Village

Figure 1

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5. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

A summary of Pablo's results is shown in **Figure 2**.

A line graph to show the average recall (%) of each word in the word list

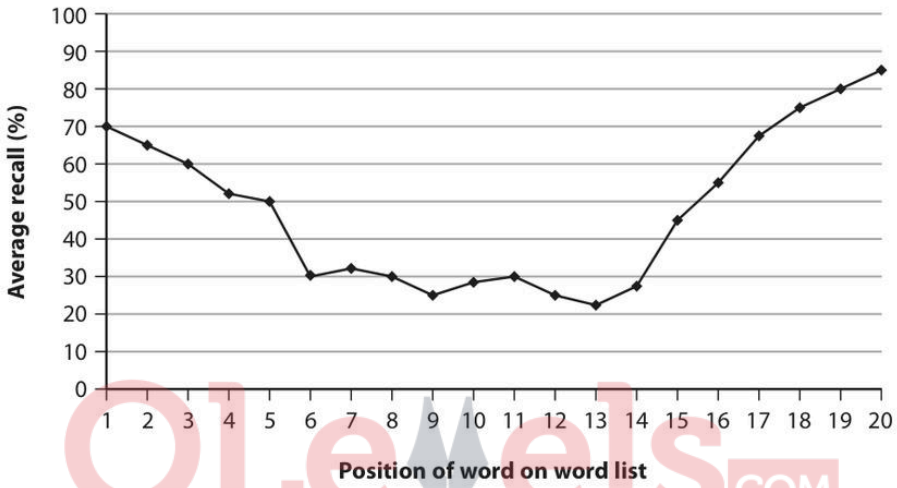


Figure 2

(a) Pablo concluded that his findings supported the Multi-Store Model of Memory.

Explain **one** reason why Pablo concluded this.

You should refer to the Multi-Store Model of Memory in your answer.

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5. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Pablo's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

5. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

4 Sergio wanted to see the influence of practice and effort on learning a new skill.

Sergio decided to show his niece and nephew how to juggle one weekend. He asked his niece to practise juggling every day for a week and when she sent him videos of her practising juggling, he sent her supportive messages and praised her effort. Sergio did not ask his nephew to practise juggling and did not send him any supportive messages.

Sergio was sent videos of his niece and nephew juggling at the beginning and the end of the week. He timed how long they could juggle for without dropping the juggling balls.

His results are shown in **Figure 2**.

A comparative bar chart to show the time (in seconds) that the niece and nephew were able to juggle at the beginning and end of the week

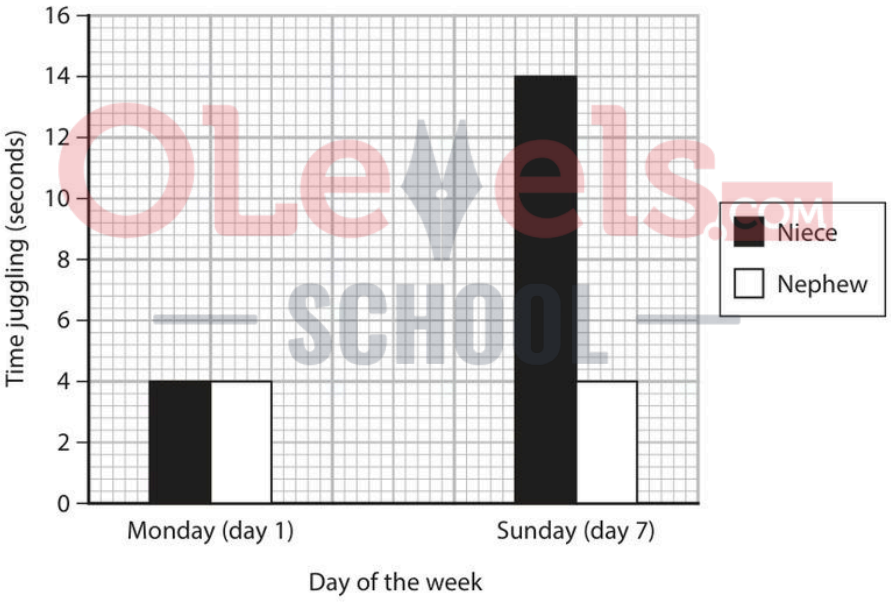


Figure 2

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made from **Figure 2** regarding the role of practice and effort in learning a new skill.

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **two** weaknesses of Sergio's investigation into the role of practice and effort in learning a new skill.

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(Total for Question 4 = 8 marks)

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

9 Simon is investigating the memory of his students. He shows his students 6 words for 15 seconds as a group. Simon removes the words and asks his students to try and remember them.

After 30 minutes, Simon asks his students to try and recall the words.

Simon's word list is shown in **Figure 1**.

Acid	Unripe	Lemon
Bitter	Sharp	Tart

Figure 1

Simon finds that some of his students recalled the word 'sour' as part of their list of words.

(a) Explain why some of the students have recalled the word 'sour' when recalling the word list.

You should refer to the Theory of Reconstructive Memory in your answer.

(2)

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7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Simon's investigation.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 9 = 6 marks)

7. Question 9 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 15 · part a · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

15 Ishfaq is investigating the impact of damage to different parts of the brain on people's lives. He recruits a unique patient who has damage to a specific part of his corpus callosum.

The patient is asked a number of open and closed ended questions during an interview of how the condition affects his life. The patient also undergoes a number of experimental tests in the laboratory, such as being presented with an object in one hand, without being able to see the object, and being asked to name it.

(a) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Ishfaq's investigation into the patient with damage to his corpus callosum.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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8. Question 15 · part a · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** problem that Ishfaq's patient may experience as a result of the damage to his corpus callosum in the experimental tasks given by Ishfaq.

You should refer to the role of the corpus callosum in your answer.

(2)

(Total for Question 15 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

9. Question 17 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

17 Mattéo is investigating the impact of a treatment to help patients with severe prosopagnosia.

Mattéo recruited 10 patients with severe prosopagnosia. He gave half of his patients an 11-week face training programme which involved showing 12 faces at different angles, with different emotional expressions. The other half of his patients were put into a control group, where they watched TV instead of being involved in the training sessions.

Before and after the investigation, all the patients had their performance on a face task recorded, which involved them deciding which of the faces resembled a target face the most.

Mattéo's average results are shown in **Table 2**.

Group	Average performance on the face task before the investigation (% correct)	Average performance on the face task after the investigation (% correct)
Training programme	41	60
Control	39	38

Table 2

(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made from the data in **Table 2**. (4)

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9. Question 17 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **two** strengths of Mattéo's study.

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(Total for Question 17 = 8 marks)

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9. Question 17 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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10. Question 19 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

19 Mikel was investigating the role of the hemispheres of the brain.

He recruited a participant with damage to their left hemisphere and another participant with damage to their right hemisphere.

Mikel gave the participants two tasks.

Task 1 – Word category task – the participant had to pick one word from a selection of four that fitted a different category of words to the other three (see **Figure 3**).

Task 2 – Shape category task – the participant had to pick one shape from a selection of four that fitted a different category of shapes to the other three (see **Figure 3**).

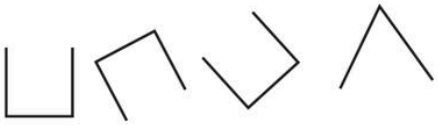
Word category task example	Shape category task example
teacher doctor lamp poet	

Figure 3

Each participant was given 25 task items to respond to and their total number of correct responses was recorded.

Mikel's results are shown in **Table 4**.

	Task 1 – percentage of correct responses	Task 2 – percentage of correct responses
Participant with damage to the left hemisphere of the brain	4%	8%
Participant with damage to the right hemisphere of the brain	92%	6%

Table 4

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10. Question 19 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made regarding the role of the hemispheres of the brain using the data in **Table 4**.

(2)

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Mikel's investigation into the role of the hemispheres of the brain.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

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(Total for Question 19 = 6 marks)

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10. Question 19 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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11. Question 20 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

20 Ada wanted to see how the presence of others could influence exercise behaviour. She went to her local gym and recruited four volunteers to take part in her study as confederates / stooges.

Ada asked the confederates / stooges to run on the majority of the five running machines in the gym during the busy two-hour period, both in the morning and afternoon sessions. The fifth running machine was always left vacant.

Ada recorded, in minutes, how long the fifth running machine was used for in the morning and afternoon sessions, over a three-day period.

Ada's findings are shown in **Table 3**.

	Average time (mins) the fifth running machine was used in the morning session		Average time (mins) the fifth running machine was used in the afternoon session	
	No confederates / stooges	With confederates / stooges	No confederates / stooges	With confederates / stooges
Monday	100	118	113	115
Tuesday	98	110	112	110
Wednesday	97	112	96	95

Table 3

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11. Question 20 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made from the data in **Table 3** in terms of conformity to majority influence.

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11. Question 20 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Ada's study.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 20 = 8 marks)

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11. Question 20 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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12. Question 23 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

23 Hannah was investigating how obedient people would be to an authority figure.

She got permission from a train station to conduct her investigation during a busy rush hour period. Passengers were requested to only leave the train station via one of the exits by an authority figure.

Hannah compared the findings from three variations:

Variation A: the request was given in person or over a loudspeaker.

Variation B: the request was given by a man who wore a uniform or casual clothes.

Variation C: the request was given by a male or female authority figure.

Hannah's results are shown in **Table 5**.

	Variation A: Authority figure presence		Variation B: Clothes worn by authority figure		Variation C: Gender of authority figure	
	In person	Loudspeaker	Uniform	Casual	Male	Female
% obedience	30	10	45	15	30	30

Table 5

(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made in terms of obedience to authority using the data in **Table 5**.

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12. Question 23 · part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Hannah's investigation.

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(Total for Question 23 = 8 marks)

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12. Question 23 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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